

Intro to Consumer Behavior & 5-Stage Model

Defining Consumer Behavior Foundations

- Consumer behavior analyzes the complex psychological and social processes determining why individuals select specific products.
- Understanding this field demands prioritizing the fundamental question of why a consumer executed a specific market action.
- Marketers utilize these behavioral insights to engineer targeted interventions that guide prospective buyers toward purchase.

The Anchor 5-Stage Buyer Framework

- The model initiates with need recognition, followed by an extensive information search to resolve the newly identified problem.
- Consumers systematically evaluate available alternatives using specific criteria before finalizing their critical purchase decision.
- The journey concludes with post-purchase behavior, where the buyer experiences either lasting satisfaction or cognitive dissonance.

Layers Influencing the Decision Journey

- Intrinsic psychological forces, including underlying motivations and selective perception, heavily shape early decision stages.
- External sociological constraints like family roles and reference groups exert immense pressure during alternative evaluation.
- Broad cultural dimensions and regional subcultures subconsciously dictate long-term brand preferences and loyalty formations.

Illustrative Application: Oishi Beverages

- Thirst triggers need recognition, prompting the consumer to actively search convenience store coolers for refreshing options.
- The buyer evaluates Oishi against competitors based on flavor profiles and pricing, ultimately executing the purchase transaction.
- Refreshment delivers immediate post-purchase satisfaction, actively reinforcing positive brand attitudes for future buying cycles.